Hyunjeong "Lacy" Rhee

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EDUCATION

2024 - Current **Ph.D. Candidate, Human Environmental Sciences, Emphasis in Textile and Apparel Management,** University of Missouri, Columbia, MO. **(**Advisor: Dr. Li Zhao, Ph.D.) – Expected graduation: May 2027
- · Data Science and Analytics Graduate Certificate (Expected March 2027)
- · Dissertation Title (Tentative): *Large Language Model-Driven Hyper-Personalization and Identity Signaling of Fashion Consumers*

2022 - 2024 **M.S., Human-Tech Convergence, Dept. of Clothing and Textiles,** Hanyang University, Seoul, South Korea. **(**Advisor: Dr. Kyu-Hye Lee, Ph.D.)
- · Honors: Summa Cum Laude (GPA: 4.50/4.50)

2015 - 2019 **B.S., Clothing and Textiles,** Hanyang University, Seoul, South Korea.
- · Honors: Summa Cum Laude (GPA: 4.01/4.50)
- · Exchange Student in Textile Design, University of Leeds, United Kingdom (2017-2018)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2020 - 2022 **Merchandising (MD) Specialist, CJ Olive Young,** Seoul, Korea.
- · Multi-channel merchandiser for color cosmetics (face/lip/eye makeup), managing assortment for 80+ planograms in 1,200+ brick-and-mortar stores and online store
- · Developed monthly omni-channel multi-brand promotion strategy and weekly online promotion calendar for makeup category
- · Managed key product strategy for 2022 Vegan Beauty campaign launch

2019 - 2020 **Merchandising Assistant, Sephora Korea Ltd.,** Seoul, Korea.
- · Managed brand/product allocation for new store openings
- · Communicated with Southeast Asia regional headquarters (Singapore) to coordinate Sephora exclusive brand/product launch timelines
- · Developed product metadata management guidelines for over 9,000 SKUs, enhancing sales analysis accuracy

2018 - 2019 **Buying Assistant**, **Samsung C&T Fashion Group**, Seoul, Korea
- · Assisted seasonal buying for menswear brand Suitsupply
- · Managed product allocation and communication for brick-and-mortar stores
- · Provided English-Korean interpretation for Suitschool (5-day staff training led by regional manager), flagship store opening, and press interviews with CEO Fokke de Jong

RESEARCH

Research Interests:

- **Human-technology interaction in fashion:** AI-mediated consumer behavior and decision-making; AI-driven hyper-personalization in fashion marketing; consumer identity and agency
- **Fashion NLP, data analytics, & computational social science:** Natural language

processing (NLP), large language models (LLMs), and machine learning; computational analysis of fashion-specific text data; evaluation and refinement of AI methods for fashion research and practice (e.g., algorithmic bias)

Peer Reviewed Research Publications:

1. **Rhee, H.,** & Lee, K.-H. (2023). The other side of green beauty consumption: The effect of eco-friendly claims on appearance enhancement attributes for makeup. *Journal of the Korean Society of Clothing and Textiles, 47*(6), 1204-1220. https://doi.org/10.5850/JKSCT.2023.47.6.1204
2. **Rhee, H.,** & Lee, K.-H. (2022). The resourcefulness of sponsored contents on social media: A netnographic approach to customer inspiration cues. *Journal of Fashion Business, 26*(6), 116-132. [KCI-Korean Citation Index], KCI IF: 1.06
3. **Rhee, H.,** Park, S. J., Jung, J. & Lee, K.-H. (2022). Fashion in live commerce: A transactional communication model-based approach. *The Journal of Korean Living Science Research, 38*(1), 46-51.

Submitted/Under Review:

1. **Rhee, H.,** Sun, X., & Zhao, L. (2026, *Under 1st review*). Interview Study on Fashion AI, Ethics, and Governance. *Clothing and Textiles Research Journal.*
2. Sun, X., **Rhee, H.,** & Zhao, L. (2026, *Under 1st revision*). Fashion NFTs and conspicuous consumption. *Journal of Fashion Marketing and Management.*
3. **Rhee, H.,** Zhao, L. (2026, *Revise & Resubmit*). Sentiment Analysis of Consumer Reviews and Text Analytics. *Journal of Fashion Marketing and Management.*

Work in Progress:

1. **Rhee, H.,** Youn, S., & Lee, K.-H. (2026, *Final manuscript, to be submitted September 2026).* Uncertainty in AI Regulations and Employee Creativity. *Target Journal: International Journal of Retail and Distribution Management.*
2. **Rhee, H.,** &. Zhao, L. (Data collection, preliminary study completed). LLM-Generated Fashion Product Descriptions and Algorithmic Bias.
3. **Rhee, H.,** &. Zhao, L. (Data Collection; Study 1 completed). An Experimental Study of AI-Generated Fashion Model Images in Product Description Pages (PDPs). *Target Journal: Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services.*

Peer Reviewed Presentations/Proceedings:

1. **Rhee, H.,** &. Zhao, L. (2026, *Accepted*). Reading Between the Stars: Extracting Pre-Purchase Expectations from Fashion Product Reviews Using Large Language Models [Poster Presentation]. *International Textile and Apparel Association Conference. Jacksonville, FL.*
2. **Rhee, H.,** Sun, X., &. Zhao, L. (2026, *Accepted*). AI in Practice: Affordances, Constraints, and Governance Gaps in the Fashion Supply Chain [Oral Presentation]. *International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference. Jacksonville, FL.*
3. Hendershott, E., **Rhee, H.,** &. Zhao, L. (2026*, Accepted*). Revisiting the Personalization-Privacy Paradox: Exploring Gen Z's Consumer Perceptions of AI-Driven Fashion Marketing [Poster Presentation]. *International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference. Jacksonville, FL.*

4. **Rhee, H.,** &. Zhao, L. (2026). *When Do Fashion Reviews Fool AI? Insights from Misclassification in Sentiment Analysis*, International Conference in Clothing and Textiles (ICCT) 2026, Seoul, South Korea. May 22-23.
    - ♦ ***2026 ICCT Best Poster Presentation Award.***
5. **Rhee, H.,** &. Zhao, L. (2025). Revisiting Fashion Product Reviews: AI-Driven Analysis of the Pre-Purchase vs. Post- Purchase Divide [Oral Presentation]. *International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference,* St. Louis, MO. November 18-22. https://doi.org/10.31274/itaa.21981
    - ♦ ***2025 ITAA Paper of Distinction Award (Consumer Behavior Track)***
6. **Rhee, H.,** &. Zhao, L. (2025). Fashion-Centric AI Integration: Navigating Challenges and Opportunities in the Fashion Industry [Poster Presentation]. *International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference,* St. Louis, MO. November 18-22. https://doi.org/10.31274/itaa.21982
7. **Rhee, H.,** & Zhao, L. (2025). Ethics in the Loop: Fashion Industry Perspectives on the Ethical Challenges of AI. International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference, St. Louis, MO. November 18-22. https://doi.org/10.31274/itaa.21983
8. **Rhee, H.** (2025). Leveraging large language models for consumer behavior analysis *[Oral Presentation]. 2025 SFTI-CMU International Conference.* Chiang Mai University, Thailand. July 18-21.
9. **Rhee, H.,** Youn, S., & Lee, K.-H. (2025). Generative AI in Retail: The Dual Effect of Capability and Regulation-Induced Uncertainty *[Poster Presentation]*. AI Symposium, University of Missouri. January 17.
10. **Rhee, H.,** Youn, S., & Lee, K.-H. (2024). The Paradox of Generative AI Creativity: AI Capability and Regulation-Induced Uncertainty. *International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference,* Long Beach, CA. November 8-11.
11. **Rhee, H.,** Youn, S., & Lee, K.-H. (2024). Tied Together as "Swifties": Insights from Consumer Reviews of Fan-Made Fashion Merchandise. *International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference,* Long Beach, CA. November 8-11.
12. **Rhee, H.,** Yun, S., Kim, T.-G., Lee, K.-H. (2024). Transparency challenges in textile and apparel sustainability: A large language model approach. *The 77th Annual Meeting of the Textile Machinery Society of Japan*, Osaka, Japan. May 30-31.
13. **Rhee, H.,** Park, D., Lee, C., & Lee, K.-H. (2024). The effect of shopping channels: Text mining reviews of beauty products. *The Society of Fashion and Textile Industry Spring Conference*, Daegu, South Korea. May 25.
14. **Rhee, H.,** Ju, N., Lee, S., & Lee, K.-H. (2024) Sustainable Standards, Situational Choices: Eco-Friendly Leather and Norm Activation. *2024 International Conference on Clothing and Textiles.* Jeju, South Korea. May 10-11.
15. **Rhee, H.,** & Lee, K.-H. (2023). Generative AI disclosure in fashion marketing: A tectonic shift in the advertising landscape. *International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference,* Baltimore, Maryland, November 8-11.
16. **Rhee, H.,** & Lee, K.-H. (2023). What going "green" costs for cosmetics: The effect of sustainability claims on colored makeup products. *International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference,* Baltimore, Maryland, November 8-11.
17. **Rhee, H.,** & Lee, K.-H. (2023). Behind the scenes of K-POP and the luxury industry: A cross-cultural Dynamic Topic Modeling approach. *International Textile and Apparel*

Association Annual Conference, Baltimore, Maryland, November 8-11.

18. **Rhee, H.,** & Lee, K.-H. (2023). Contemporary cultural capital: Through the lens of social media. *The Society of Fashion and Textile Industry Fall Conference*, FITI Testing & Research Institute, Seoul, November 4.
19. **Rhee, H.,** & Lee, K.-H. (2023). Reselling fashion in the digital age: A cross-cultural text analysis. *The Korean Society of Fashion Business Fall Conference*, Youngone Corporation Myeongdong Building, Seoul, October 28.
20. Seon, J.-H., **Rhee, H.,** & Lee, K.-H. (2023.) The effect of advertising repetition for nostalgic fashion marketing. *The Society of Fashion and Textile Industry Spring Conference*, Keimyung University, Daegu, May 20.
21. **Rhee, H.,** & Lee, K.-H. (2023). The effect of sustainability claims on makeup product perception: A web-based experimental approach. *The Society of Fashion and Textile Industry Spring Conference,* Keimyung University, Daegu, May 20.
22. **Rhee, H.,** Youn, S., & Lee, K.-H. (2023). Social media and self-presentation: The application of intentionality theory [Oral presentation]. *The Society of Fashion and Textile Industry Spring Conference,* Keimyung University, Daegu, May 20.
23. **Rhee, H.,** Park, S. J., Jung, J., & Lee, K.-H. (2023). Persuasive communication strategies in fashion product live commerce: An interactional model of communication approach. *The Korean Society of Clothing and Textiles Spring Conference,* Chung-Ang University, Seoul, April 15.
24. **Rhee, H.,** & Lee, K.-H. (2023). Luxury brand marketing and K-pop key opinion leaders. *The Korean Society of Clothing and Textiles Spring Conference,* Chung-Ang University, Seoul, April 15.
25. **Rhee, H.,** & Lee, K.-H. (2022). Consumers' perception of vegan makeup products: A social media big data analysis. *The Society of Fashion and Textile Industry Fall Conference*, Ewha University, Seoul, October 29.

TEACHING

Teaching Interests:

- Digital merchandising, omnichannel retailing, supply chain management, technology in fashion, fashion entrepreneurship, fashion branding, and consumer behavior
- Retail merchandising analytics, retail math, and consumer research
- AI applications in fashion, fashion data analytics, data visualization, and text analytics

Independently Taught Courses at the University of Missouri (Graduate Instructor)

2026, Fall **TAM4300 Fashion Brand Management and Promotion,** Online, 3 credits (80 students)
Undergraduate/graduate course examining fashion branding strategy, brand equity, and promotion through real-world case studies and applied brand development.

2024, Fall-2026, Spring **TAM2100 Introduction to Digital Presentation Techniques,** Online, 3 credits (up to 200 students)
Undergraduate course covering digital merchandising and presentation software to TAM and non-TAM major students (Microsoft Excel & PowerPoint, Adobe Illustrator & Express, Canva); Coordinated professional portfolio websites for student final projects, integrating skills and outputs across multiple digital tools and course modules

Courses Assisted at the University of Missouri (Graduate Teaching Assistant)

2026, Fall **TAM 2600: Moral & Ethical Issues in the Global Fashion Supply Chain (Writing-Intensive, In-Person)**
- Writing intensive course focusing on ethical issues in fashion
- Assisted students with topic research, in-class and online discussion, academic source search and evaluation, academic essay writing, and peer reviews
- Led two undergraduate peer learning assistants (PLAs) as TA leader

2026, Spring **TAM 4400/7400: The Retail Consumer: Advanced Data Analytics (In-Person)**
- Led in-person lectures and discussion for 4 sessions (Session topics: Descriptive statistics, inferential statistics, variable types, and significance testing in consumer survey research)
- Provided individualized support on aligning research questions, hypotheses, measures, and analytical methods for students' final research projects; Guided students through hypotheses development, selection of statistical analyses based on data types, and step-by-step interpretation of results
- Final presentation coordination, in-person office hours, assignment grading

2026, Spring **TAM 4600/7600: Digital Merchandising (Hybrid: In-Person & Online)**
- Led in-person lectures and discussion for 3 sessions (Session topics: A/B testing, Email and mobile marketing, AI/Search engine optimization and digital disruptions)
- Guided students through experiential real-world merchandising decisions through Stukent SIMternship digital merchandising simulation
- Final presentation coordination, in-person office hours, assignment grading

2025, Fall **TAM 3480: Apparel Technical Design (In-Person)**
- Supported in-class CLO 3D instruction and student apparel line development in collaboration with industry partners
- In-person office hours, assignment grading

2025, Fall **TAM 4300/7300: Fashion Brand Management and Promotion (Online)**
- Managed weekly Canvas modules and provided feedback on Harvard Business Review case study projects and re-branding strategy development projects
- In-person office hours, assignment grading

2025, Fall **TAM 1200: Basic Concepts of Apparel Design and Production (In-Person)**
- Led in-person lectures and discussion for 2 sessions (Session topics: Apparel quality control, Apparel brand management)
- In-person office hours, assignment grading

2024, Fall **TAM 3300: Retail Merchandising Analysis (In-Person)**
- In-class assistance with seasonal open-to-buy, markup, gross margin, pricing, and inventory analyses using Microsoft Excel
- Led in-person lecture for 1 session (Session topic: Retail analytics and fashion and beauty industry)
- In-person office hours, assignment grading

Courses Assisted at Hanyang University (Graduate Teaching Assistant)

2023 – 2024 C-T4031: Data Mining Research in Fashion Consumption Culture (Capstone)

- Advised senior Clothing and Textiles students on developing fashion consumer research questions using text-mining methods.
- Guided projects through online text data collection, preprocessing, analysis, interpretation, and web-based presentation of findings.
- Developed 4 student projects for academic conference presentation as co-author.

2022 - 2023 GEN9176: Big Data Fashion Trend

- Advised undergraduate students from non-Clothing and Textiles majors on developing consumer trend research questions using text-mining methods.
- Guided students through online text data collection, preprocessing, analysis, interpretation, and web-based presentation of findings.
- Developed 2 student projects for academic conference presentation as co-author.

Guest Lectures/Invited Talks

2026 ***(How) Does AI Understand Fashion? Natural Language Processing (NLP) and Large Language Models (LLMs) in Fashion.*** In-Class Guest Lecture for TAM 4000/7000: Digital Marketing Strategies in Fashion (September 15th)

2026 ***K-Consumers: Navigating South Korean Consumer Behavior in a Global Context.*** In-Class Guest Lecture for TAM 2400: Global Consumers (April 21st)

2025 ***AI Applications in Fashion Marketing: Data, Language, and Creativity.*** In-Class Guest Lecture for TAM 4000/7000: Digital Marketing Strategies in Fashion (September 11th),

2024 ***K-Consumers: Navigating South Korean Consumer Behavior in a Global Context*** In-Class Guest Lecture for TAM 2400: Global Consumers (November 14th)

2024 ***Retail & Merchandising Strategy in the Health & Beauty Industry.*** In-Class Guest Lecture for TAM 3300 Retail & Merchandise Analysis (November 7th**)**

2024 ***Present Online: Digital Marketing in the Fashion & Beauty Industry.*** In-Class Guest Lecture for TAM 4000/7000: Digital Marketing Strategies in Fashion (September 10th)

2022 ***Omni-channel Retail and Marketing Strategy.*** In-Class Guest Lecture for C-T424: Fashion Marketing & Branding (November 22nd), Hanyang University.

STUDENT MENTORSHIP

2026 **Undergraduate Research Mentor,** University of Missouri
Mentored an undergraduate student in literature review, research design, data collection, and preparation for conference attendance; co-authored research accepted for presentation at the 2026 ITAA Annual Conference.

AWARDS, HONORS, & SCHOLARSHIP FUNDING

Awards – Academic/Conference

2026 **Best Poster Presentation Award,** International Conference of Clothing and Textiles (ICCT). Rhee, H. & Zhao, L. *When Do Fashion Reviews Fool AI? Insights from Misclassification in Sentiment Analysis.*

2025 **Paper of Distinction - Consumer Behavior Track,** International Textile and Apparel Association Conference in St. Louis, MO. Rhee, H. & Zhao, L. *Revisiting Fashion Product Reviews: AI-Driven Analysis of the Pre-Purchase vs. Post-Purchase Divide.*

2023 **Excellent Poster Presentation**, *Korean Society of Fashion and Textile Industry Spring Conference*, Keimyung University, Daegu, Korea.

2022 **Excellent Poster Presentation**, *Korean Society of Fashion and Textile Industry Fall Conference*, Ewha Womens University, Seoul, Korea.

Awards - Honors/Recognition

2025 **Graduate Leadership & Engagement Recognition Award,** University of Missouri Graduate School.

2025 **Graduate Professional Council (GPC) Conference Presentation Travel Award,** University of Missouri

2024 **Graduate Professional Council (GPC) Conference Presentation Travel Award,** University of Missouri

2024 **Outstanding Researcher Award (Conference Presentation),** Master's Student Level, Hanyang University

2022 **BK[Brain Korea] 21 Outstanding Graduate Student Award,** Hanyang University

2018 **Excellence Award**, Graduation Fashion Show, Dept. of Clothing and Textiles

2016 **2nd Place Award**, Presentation of Academic English Contest, Hanyang University

Awards - Scholarship/Fellowship

2026 - 2027 **Fisher Ames Rhymes Memorial Scholarship Fund,** College of Arts and Sciences. University of Missouri. (Total: $1,500)

2025 **Marjorie Joseph Fellowship (Outstanding Beginning Doctoral Student Award),** International Textile and Apparel Association. (Total: $1,000)

2025 - 2026 **Richard W. Brookshire and Jung Ha-Brookshire Endowed Graduate Award in Textile and Apparel Management,** University of Missouri **(**Total: $1,000)

2024 - 2025 **Marion K. and Vernon W. Piper Distinguished Doctoral Fellowship,** University of Missouri **(**Total: $7,000)

2024 **Hanyang Scholarship for Study Abroad,** Hanyang University (Total: $11,000)

2022 - 2024 **BK21 Four Fellowship,** National Research Foundation Korea (Total ≈ $6,500)

2022 - 2024 **Hanyang University RA Scholarship,** Hanyang University

2022 - 2024 **Hanyang University TA Scholarship,** Hanyang University

2022 - 2024 **Leadership Merit Based Scholarship,** Hanyang University

2022 - 2024 **Graduation Honors Merit-Based Scholarship,** Hanyang University **(**Total ≈ $9,800)

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Research and Technical Training:

Tableau Training, Data Science Executive Week, University of Missouri Institute of Data Science and Informatics - March 2026

AI Foundations for Graduate Research Excellence Workshop, University of Missouri - March 2026

Fundamentals of Natural Language Processing (Online Certificate), University of Colorado Boulder - February 2026

An Introduction to Peer Review (Online Certificate), Web of Science – December 2025

Grants 201 Workshop, The Graduate School, University of Missouri. - September 2025

Grants 101 Workshop, The Graduate School, University of Missouri – September 2025

Next-Gen Philosophical Foundations of AI Workshop, University of Missouri – April 2025

Teaching & Professional Development:

Teaching Assistant Writing Intensive Workshop 2026, MU Teaching for Learning Center. – August 2026

Grad/Postdoc Effective Teaching Badge (Alternative Digital Credential earned through 3 training sessions), MU Teaching for Learning Center - September 2025 – October 2025

New York City Experiential Learning Industry Study Tour, University of Missouri. - May 2025

First Year Scholars Program, University of Missouri. - September 2024 – May 2025

Online Teaching Certification Seminar (OTCS), University of Missouri. – August 2024

COMMITTEE SERVICE/LEADERSHIP

President, GSA-TAM (Graduate Student Association of Textile and Apparel Management), University of Missouri, 2026 – Current

Presider, International Textile and Apparel Association (ITAA) Annual Conference, 2026

Undergraduate Student Resume Review (Career Fair), Textile and Apparel Management, University of Missouri, 2025

Social Chair, GSA-TAM, University of Missouri, 2025 - Current

Graduate Professional Council Representative (Textile and Apparel Management), University of Missouri, 2025 – 2026

Conference Registration Volunteer, International Textile and Apparel Association (ITAA) Annual Conference, 2025

Editorial Assistant, *Fashion and Textiles*, December 2023 – April 2024

Student Assistant for Organization Committee, The Korean Society of Clothing and Textiles Spring Conference, May 2023

Graduate Student College Representative, College of Human Ecology, Hanyang University, November 2022 – August 2024

Committee Member, Dept. of Clothing and Textiles Homecoming Day Organization Committee, Hanyang University, December 2022 – January 2023

Committee Member, Graduation Fashion Show Organization Committee, Dept. of Clothing and Textiles, March 2018 – May 2018

Undergraduate Student Representative, Dept. of Clothing and Textiles, March 2018 – May 2018

Undergraduate Student Board, College of Human Ecology, March 2015 – February 2016

SKILLS

- **Computational Methods and Programming:** Python, R; natural language processing (NLP), topic modeling, sentiment analysis, text classification, large language models (LLMs), machine learning, data preprocessing, data visualization
- **Quantitative Methods:** SPSS, R, SmartPLS; structural equation modeling (SEM), experimental survey design, multilevel modeling
- **Qualitative Methods:** MAXQDA, Interview research; qualitative text analysis, thematic analysis
- **Languages:** Korean (Native), English (Full Professional Proficiency)

OTHER ACTIVITIES

Social Media Ambassador, Tamburins (Owned by Gentle Monster), October 2018 - November 2018

Community Service (30 hours), College of Human Ecology, June 2018

Team Leader, Fashion Magazine HY-Genic, Hanyang University, March 2016 - January 2017

Member, Fashion Magazine HY-Genic, Hanyang University, March 2015 - January 2017

Member, College Dance Team, College of Human Ecology, March 2016 - May 2017

Member, College Band Club, College of Human Ecology, March 2015 - May 2017